

19 · More settling bought retention at a cost

Legacy 50M ePC base with the v0 live cap: zsRE, three exposed realizations, order 100, after 1,000 edits.

Settling steps	Original-prompt retention	Paraphrase retention	Learning time per cell
1	51.5%	13.1%	5.7 min
8	53.4%	13.1%	10.2 min
32	56.5%	12.2%	25.4 min

Mean ordinary-text loss increase rose from 0.00145 to 0.00221 nats between one and 32 steps. CounterFact paraphrase retention stayed at zero.

More inference preserved more teaching prompts, but did not establish better transfer or lower harm.

Source: PC-controls report. Means over three realizations; timing is learning only, not whole-process time.